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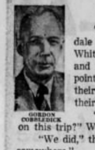
# Plain Dealing

## Piersall Quits Clowning to Make Determined Bid for Tribe's Center Field Job


GORDON COBBLEDICK

By GORDON COBBLEDICK
Plain Dealer Sports Editor

TUCSON, Ariz.—This was in Scottsdale 10 days or so ago, when Sammy White belonged to the Boston Red Sox and nobody was disposed to argue the point. The Indians had just emerged from their clubhouse and were engaged in their pre-game warmup.

"How come you didn't bring Piersall on this trip?" White asked Joe Gordon.

"We did," the Flash assured him. "He's around somewhere."

"Then," White demanded, "why don't I hear him?"

### Piersall Now Tribe's Quiet Man

He was told that the silence, unaccustomed to one who knew him in another time and other circumstances, came from the new Jimmy Piersall, now known as the quiet man of the Cleveland training camp.

White shook his head incredulously.

"Is he sick?" he asked with obvious anxiety.

"No, he's well—maybe weller than he's been in a long time," said Gordon. "Frank Lane wrote him a letter back in the winter, you know, and told him he should keep his mouth shut and concentrate on playing ball. It worked."

At this point a member of the Indians entourage, who needn't be identified, interjected a question.

"Who's going to write Frank Lane a letter?"

Since it was without pertinence, the flippancy won't be discussed further. The subject of this essay is, in any case, the new Jimmy Piersall, as serious and as hard-working a candidate as there is among all the Indians.

There can be little doubt at this writing that, if the season were opening today, Piersall would be the Indians' leadoff batter and center fielder.

### Hasn't Yet Won Center Field Job

He hasn't won his fight with Carroll Hardy for the right to play the position he has filled with greater or less distinction (last year it was less) since becoming a major leaguer in 1953. But no one—probably not even Hardy himself—will deny that he's leading at this stage of the contest.

There isn't much to choose between them defensively which is as rich a compliment as it is possible to pay Hardy. But Piersall is hitting the ball with more authority, and that alone is enough to give him an edge in what shaped up as the only important contest for a place in the Indians' line-up.

It isn't what he has done and is doing, however, that impresses observers here. It's the manner in which he is going about his work. Jimmy Piersall the clown is dead. Piersall the professional baseball player is alive and fighting.

### Won't Pose for Gags

When the photographers and reporters arrived here from Cleveland a month ago they expected, of course, that Piersall would oblige by posing for gag pictures and by talking his own delightful variety of nonsense.

He refused courteously, but firmly. The newspaper people, being cynics by birth and training, predicted confidently that the reformation would last, at best, a few days. But it has lasted more than five weeks and shows no signs of weakening.

The old Piersall disappointed Cleveland last year. The new Piersall, dedicated to the job of playing ball, can be a tremendous asset.

A good guess at this point is that he will be.

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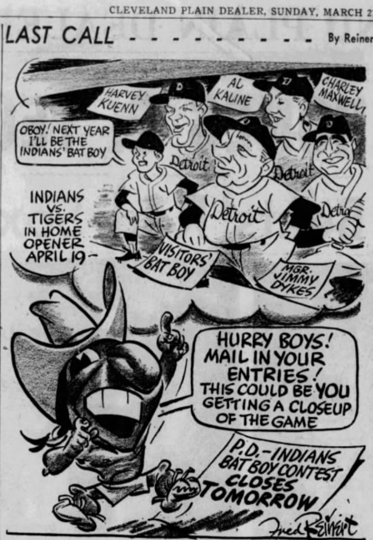
## LAST CALL - - - - - - - - - - By Reinert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OBOY! NEXT YEAR I'LL BE THE INDIANS' BAT BOY
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INDIANS VS. TIGERS IN HOME OPENER APRIL 19—
VISITORS' BAT BOY
MGR. JIMMY DYKES
HURRY BOYS! MAIL IN YOUR ENTRIES! THIS COULD BE YOU GETTING A CLOSEUP OF THE GAME
P.D.-INDIANS BAT BOY CONTEST CLOSES TOMORROW
Fred Reinert

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# Bat Boy Contest Ends Tomorrow

The 14th annual Plain Dealer-Cleveland Indians bat boy contest is nearing the end.

Deadline is midnight tomorrow night. All completed entry blanks must be in the hands of the bat boy editor by that time or postmarked before midnight.

There still is time to get into the competition by picking up an entry blank at the Plain Dealer sports department after 4 p.m. today and tomorrow.

The contest was started by Bill Veeck in 1947 and the rules haven't changed much over the years. Now the age limitations are 13 to 17 but the big thing still is that essay on "Why I would like to be bat boy for the Cleveland Indians."

**Flanagan First Winner**

Initial winner was Jackie Flanagan of St. Ignatius High School and he was followed by Bill Sheridan. Those first three years the first choice of the judges became the bat boy for the Indians and the runner-up served in the same capacity for the visiting teams.

Then in 1950 it was decided that the winner of the contest would serve his apprenticeship with the visitors. So Tom Smith, second choice the previous year, moved over to the first base dugout. That was the spring when little Owen McGinty captured the hearts of the judges and was selected for the top prize.

Bill Domhoff, a Rocky River boy, won in 1951 and Steve Spaeth, who was attending Moses Cleveland Junior High School, took the honors the following year.

**Klug Wins in 1953**

Then came Harold Klug, a 14-year-old from Kirk Junior High School, and he was followed by Jack Hoban of Willoughby who was an eighth-grade student at Immaculate Conception grammar school.

They were followed by Dick Beres of Benedictine, a good high school pitcher; Dick Supelak of Rhodes High School; Chuck Workman, a fine all-around athlete at Lakewood, and Tom Hayes of St. Ignatius.

Winner last year was John Apanites who played second base for Collinwood High School and is trying out for that team right now. John will be serving this season as the Indians bat boy and plans to use the $1,000 prize toward his college education at John Carroll where he will enter in the fall.

There still is time to get in the competition—and that winner may be you.

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## A's Score 4 in Sixth to Defeat Nats

ORLANDO, Fla. (AP)—Kansas City hopped on Bill Fischer for four runs in the sixth inning yesterday and defeated the Washington Senators, 7-5.

The Senators fashioned an early lead on home runs by Harmon Killebrew and Bob Allison.

Rookie Ken Johnson held the Senators to one run over the last four frames to get the victory.

Kansas City .. 101 004 010— 7 11 4
Washington .. 200 111 000— 5 10 4

Hall, K. Johnson 7 and P. Daley; Hyde, Fischer 6 and Naragon. W—Hall. L—Fischer.

Home runs—Washington, Killebrew, Allison.

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## Jackson of Cards First to Travel 9

ST. PETERSBURG, Fla. (UPI)—St. Louis righthander Larry Jackson yesterday became the first major league pitcher to go nine innings this spring as the Cardinals defeated the Philadelphia Phillies, 3-2, for their seventh victory in the last eight games.

For the Cardinals, Chris Cannizzaro, 21-year-old catcher, hit two singles in three tries, giving him 11 hits in his last 18 trips.

Philadelphia .. 000 101 000— 2 9 0
St. Louis ..... 000 210 00x— 3 8 2

Owens, Mason 6 and Dalrymple; Jackson and Cannizzaro. W—Jackson. L—Owens.

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## Fred Corcoran Wins Golf Award

CHICAGO (AP)—Fred J. Corcoran, 55, one of professional golf's most prominent behind-the-scenes men, has been named winner of the William D. Richardson trophy for outstanding contribution to the game of golf.

The trophy is presented annually by the Golf Writers' Association of America.

Corcoran is tournament director for the International Golf Association, and business manager for the Ladies' Professional Golf Association.

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### France Rugby Victor

CARDIFF, Wales (AP)—France, last year's winner of the 5-nation Rugby Union tournament, kept in the race for the 1960 title by defeating Wales, 16-8, yesterday.

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# Andy Cohen Hits Majors 3rd Time

By ARTHUR DALEY
© New York Times Service

CLEARWATER, Fla.—When Andy Cohen joined the Giants in 1926, he merely had to beat out Frank Frisch for the job at second base. No one was beating Frisch for anything in those days.

A year later the Fordham Flash had been traded for Rogers Hornsby and the Rajah took over the job at second. No one could beat our Hornsby, either.

But in 1928, both had departed and Andy Cohen was the Giant second baseman. In no time at all he was the darling of the East Side, the Bronx, Bensonhurst and way stations. So sensational was his hitting that a tabloid began printing a daily box, comparing Cohen's average of .400-plus with Hornsby's .250-minus.

**Back After 30 Years**

Andy Cohen laughed delightedly as he recounted that story. The soft-spoken Texan from El Paso is back in the big leagues again after an absence of 31 years. He's as happy and as shiny-eyed in his job as coach of the Phils as he was in 1926 when he joined the Giants after the skimpy apprenticeship of a half-season in the Texas League and three years at the University of Alabama.

"For a rookie I didn't do bad," he said. "I hit a respectable .274. But Hornsby hit .387 to win another batting championship. Naturally, I wasn't in his class. But nobody else was, either.

"I got an awful lot of publicity that year. They said I was the Jewish ball player John McGraw always wanted. But McGraw was primarily interested in good ball players although I know he felt that a Jewish one wouldn't do any harm at the gate.

"In a way, I had two debuts, two games that stand out in my mind above all others. The first was my first at bat as a big leaguer. It was in 1926 and, oddly enough, I went in as a pinch hitter.

**Couldn't Unbutton Jacket**

"I was wearing a mackinaw and was so excited I couldn't unbutton it. So I ripped off the buttons. 'No regard for expense, eh?' said McGraw. And, of all things, I got a hit. McGraw was smiling when I got back to the bench. 'Congratulations, young man,' he said. 'You are now leading the league in hitting.'

"A great man was McGraw. The next year he had Hornsby and he asked me if I wanted to sit on the bench or go to the minors. I took the minors. 'That's what I wanted to hear you say,' he said. So I went to Buffalo, hit .354 and came back to the Giants the next season as a regular.

"My second debut was opening day of 1928. I had three hits and either drove in or scored all five of our runs. The fans poured out of the stands and carried me on their shoulders all the way to the clubhouse steps."

Those were glorious days for Andy and his buddy on the Giants was a huge Boston Irishman named Shanty Hogan.

"We were in vaudeville together, telling stories and singing parodies, in an act called 'Cohen and Hogan' — except in Boston. Then we smartly switched billing and had it 'Hogan and Cohen.' We got $1,800 a week and, if we didn't kill vaudeville, we sure helped.

"After the 1929 season McGraw traded me off to Newark and I went great. I was hitting .318 and set an International League record of 59 consecutive games without an error. So Mac came over to see me. 'Andy,' he said, 'I'm bringing you back.' That day I broke my leg.

"So, I've had a long wait to get back, more than 30 years. It's worth waiting for, too, because there's nothing in life quite like the big leagues."

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### Wheelchair Basketball

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(Championship Final)
California (Flying Wheels) 48, Long Island (N. Y.) 43

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